

ACTIVITY 4 — LEARNER WORKSHEET**PDCA Small Improvement Project Charter**

TYPE	DURATION	DMAIC PHASE	MAPS TO
Elective Activity	45 min	DEFINE	A1, A2

Name	
Date	

What you are doing

Not every improvement needs a full DMAIC project. Use PDCA to charter a small, fast improvement that a Yellow Belt can run under guidance — with a problem statement, a measurable goal and a defined check point.

What you will produce: A one-page PDCA charter with a solution-free problem statement, a measurable goal, an explicit in/out scope table and a stated decision rule.

Tools and techniques: PDCA cycle, problem/goal statements, scope in-out, stakeholder list

The scenario

Contoso Service Desk handles employee IT requests. Employees complain that tickets take too long to be assigned, that they must keep chasing for status, and that agents apply different definitions of what counts as "resolved". Handoffs between the front line and the specialist queues are unclear, and although ticket data exists it is inconsistent. You are supporting the improvement team as a Yellow Belt — you do not lead the project.

Two weeks of data have been collected: 400 tickets, of which 96 contained at least one defect, with 120 defects recorded in total across 6 defect opportunities per ticket. Mean assignment time is 55 minutes (median 46) against a 30-minute improvement goal. The CSV files in this activity's data/ folder are that extract.

Files in this activity folder**templates/ — the worksheets you complete:**

- pdca-charter.csv (section, content)

Open these in Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice Calc. Work on a copy so the originals stay clean for revision.

Baseline figures for the goal statement come from data/daily-summary.csv.

Your steps

1. Map the four PDCA phases to concrete actions for your scenario.
2. Write the problem statement: process, time period, measurable issue and impact — no solution.
3. Write a measurable goal statement: metric, baseline, target and date.
4. Define scope with an explicit in-scope / out-of-scope table to prevent scope creep.
5. Identify stakeholders and the decision you will make after the Check phase.
6. Confirm the improvement is small enough to test within two weeks.

Your working space

Complete every field. You may keep this worksheet and refer to it during the open-book assessment.

Step 1 — Map the four PDCA phases to concrete actions for your scenario.

Step 2 — Write the problem statement: process, time period, measurable issue and impact — no s...

Step 3 — Write a measurable goal statement: metric, baseline, target and date.

Step 4 — Define scope with an explicit in-scope / out-of-scope table to prevent scope creep.

Step 5 — Identify stakeholders and the decision you will make after the Check phase.

Step 6 — Confirm the improvement is small enough to test within two weeks.

Answers to the discussion prompts

1. Does your problem statement name a cause or a solution anywhere? Remove it.

2. What would make you ABANDON rather than ADAPT the pilot?

3. Who must agree the scope before work starts?

Reflect & discuss

What small improvement could you charter at work within two weeks?

Who would need to be in the room for it to stick?

Check your work

Your goal statement contains a metric, a baseline, a target and a date, and your problem statement names no solution.